



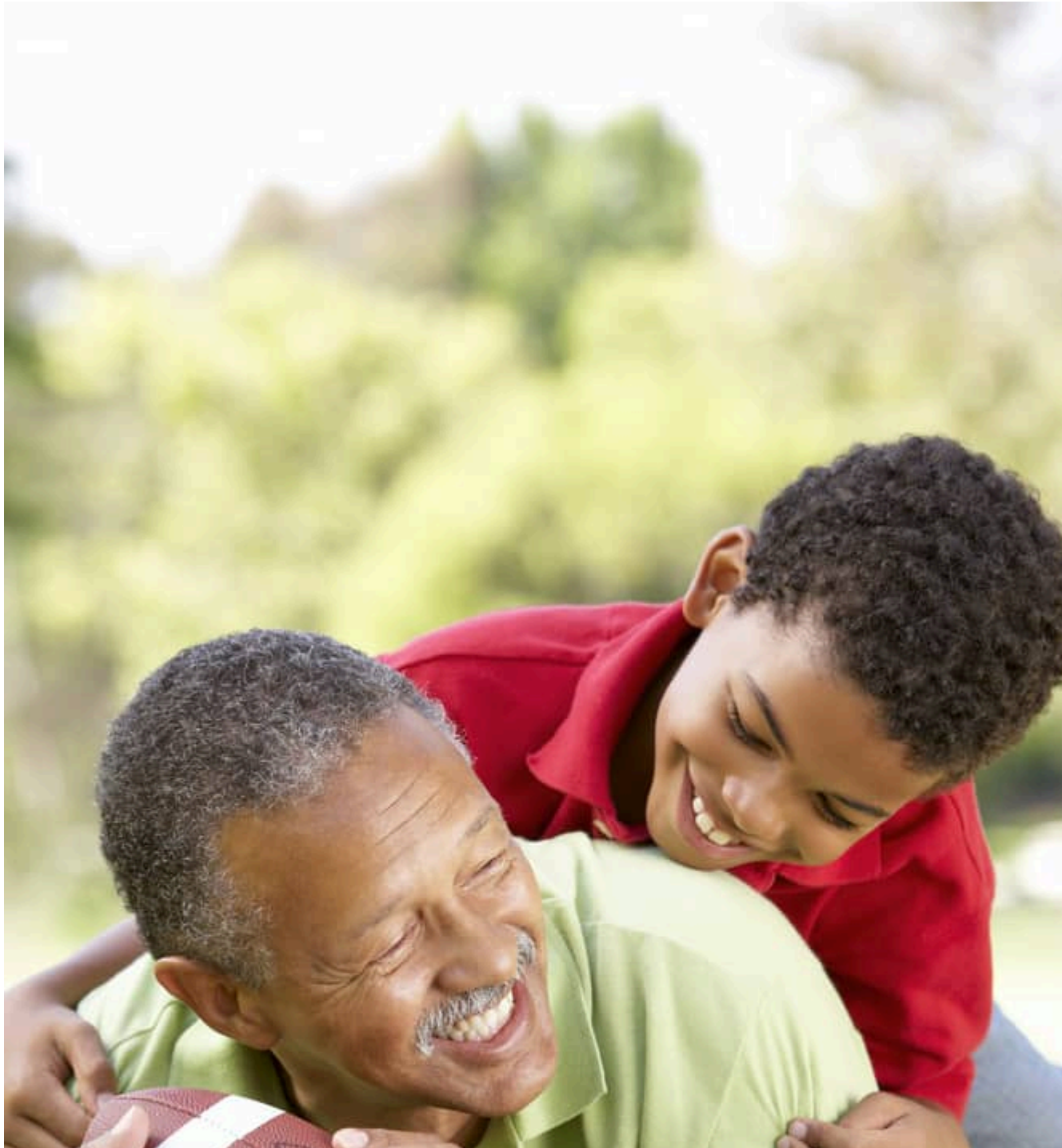
National Institute of
Diabetes and Digestive
and Kidney Diseases

Risk Factors for Type 2 Diabetes

Your chances of developing [type 2 diabetes](#) depend on a combination of risk factors. Although you can't change risk factors related to family history, age, race, or ethnicity, you may be able to avoid some risk factors by maintaining a healthy weight and being physically active.¹

Read about risk factors for type 2 diabetes below, and see which ones apply to you. Acting on the factors you can change may help delay or [prevent type 2 diabetes](#).

What are the risk factors for type 2 diabetes?





Diabetes type 2 can affect people at any age.

You can develop type 2 diabetes at any age, even during childhood. You are more likely to develop type 2 diabetes if you¹

- are [overweight or have obesity](#).
- are age 35 or older. Children and teens can also develop type 2 diabetes, but the risk increases as a person gets older.
- have a family history of diabetes.
- are African American, American Indian, Asian American, Hispanic/Latino, or Pacific Islander.
- are not physically active, because of physical limitations, a sedentary lifestyle, or a job that requires sitting for long periods of time.
- have [prediabetes](#).
- have a history of [gestational diabetes](#), a type of diabetes that develops during pregnancy, or gave birth to a baby weighing 9 pounds or more.

Children and teens are also at higher risk of developing type 2 diabetes if, in addition to the previous risk factors, they were born with a low birth weight or if their parent had gestational diabetes while pregnant with the child.¹

You are encouraged to talk with a doctor about any of the health conditions listed above that may require medical treatment. Managing health problems may help reduce your chances of developing type 2 diabetes.² Also, ask your doctor about any medicines you or your child take that might increase your risk. You can also take the [Diabetes Risk Test](#) to learn more about your risk for type 2 diabetes.

Does your weight put you at risk for type 2 diabetes?

If you have overweight or obesity, you may be able to prevent or delay type 2 diabetes by losing weight and being more physically active.¹

To see if your weight may put you at risk for type 2 diabetes, learn your [body mass index \(BMI\) and waist circumference](#) .

Body mass index

Your BMI can help you tell if you are at a [healthy weight](#) or have overweight or obesity.

Most adults with a BMI of 25 or higher are overweight and have a higher risk of developing type 2 diabetes.² Asian Americans are overweight if their BMI is 23 or higher,¹ while Pacific Islanders are overweight if their BMI is 26 or higher.^{3,4,5}

If you are age 20 or older, use the [BMI calculator for adults](#)  to learn your body mass index.

You can use a different [BMI calculator for children or teens](#)  ages 2–19 years. This calculator uses BMI, sex, and age to estimate if a child or teen has overweight or obesity.

Waist circumference

Another way to estimate your risk of developing diabetes is to measure your waist circumference. Men have a higher risk of developing diabetes if their waist circumference is more than 40 inches, while women who are not pregnant have a higher risk if their waist circumference is more than 35 inches.^{6,7}

Waist circumference is an indirect measurement of the amount of fat in your abdomen. Having a large waist circumference is a risk factor for diabetes and heart disease, even if you have a normal BMI.

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